



Australian Government
Department of Education

The Grove Academy - North Wollongong
16 - 20 Belmore Street
WOLLONGONG NSW 2500

Date of Approval: 14/11/2025

Approval of funding application for the Inclusion Development Fund Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited Support

I am pleased to advise that a delegate of the Commonwealth Department of Education has made the decision to approve The Grove Academy - North Wollongong ("You") for funding from the Australian Government's Inclusion Support Program (ISP) Inclusion Development Fund (IDF) Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited Support. This letter confirms details of the Approval which will also be available in the Inclusion Support Portal (IS Portal), and your Child Care Management Software.

This Approval Letter, together with the Conditions of Funding, make up the agreement between the Commonwealth and You in relation to how the IDF Subsidy, for which you have been approved, will be used. You will be able to claim funding in accordance with this Approval Letter and the Conditions of Funding, as agreed at the time of submitting the application. The Conditions of Funding are attached to this letter for your reference.

Summary of Approval:

1. This approval is for 15 hours per week for 10 weeks to be utilised during the approval period. All educators, including the additional educator, share the work required to support the participation of all children in the care environment. The approval period includes additional weeks to provide flexibility to enable the service to claim all funded weeks. Please note: the number of funded weeks which the service can claim are as stated.
2. It is an approval requirement for the service to complete the Strategic Inclusion Plan (SIP) for this care environment if this has not already been done, or update the Barriers, Strategies and Actions to ensure the inclusion planning reflects the current care environment. This includes the service identifying the Barriers to inclusion for all children and the Strategies and Actions required to address these Barriers.

Service Name	The Grove Academy - North Wollongong
CCS Approval ID	190081644S
Child Care Service Type	CBDC

Strategic Inclusion Plan ID	4-KUHHGET
Care Environment	Voyagers Room
IS Case ID	4-L2LKP6M
Approval Period	17/11/2025 – 22/02/2026

Detailed Approval details:

Approved number of Non Face-to-Face hours over the approval period ¹	0000006:00
Number of Operational Weeks ²	10

¹ See New ISP Guidelines Version 2.4 September 2022

² Operational Weeks have been used to calculate the funding entitlement over the Approval period of the IS Case.

Weekly Approved Hours

IDF Subsidy-Immediate Support:

Maximum number of subsidised hours per week	0000015:00
---	------------

Approved Case Hours

IDF Subsidy-Immediate Support:

Maximum number of subsidised hours over the approval period	0000150:00
---	------------

Approved child

The following child has been approved for this IS Case:

Ethan Dee

Acceptance of this approval

You agreed to the Conditions of Funding of the IDF Subsidy under the ISP upon submission of your IDF Subsidy application. When You submit your first claim for the IDF Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited support, this is considered Your acceptance of the approval as outlined in this approval letter.

If You choose not to accept the Conditions of Funding for this approval please contact the IDF Manager within 10 business days of the start date of the Approval Period.

Acceptance of this approval is limited to 60 days from the start date of the approval period, meaning services must submit a claim for payment within this time. If claims are not submitted within 60 days the case will automatically be withdrawn and no claims can be submitted.

If You have been unable to submit claims due to unexpected circumstances, such as an eligible child not attending the service due to illness during this period, You should make early contact with the IDF Manager to discuss.

Claiming the IDF Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited Support

Services receive payment for the IDF Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited support by submitting claims retrospectively through the Child Care Management System. **As a Condition of Funding, You must submit claims within 60 days of the fortnight the eligible child/ren listed on the approved case attended the service (60 day rule).**

When submitting claims, services are required to:

- identify the Additional Educator
- outline the hours the Additional Educator attended the care environment, and
- provide details of the eligible child in the care environment, including their enrolment and attendance information.

If a service does not submit any claims for more than 60 days during the approval period, the IS Case will automatically be inactivated and new claims cannot be submitted. Cases can be reactivated at the agreement of the IDF Manager, and once reactivated, new claims must be submitted according to the 60 day rule. If a service requires their case to be reactivated, they should contact the IDF Manager.

Further information on the 60 day rule is available in the New ISP Guidelines Version 2.4 September 2022. The Program Guidelines are available at www.education.gov.au/child-care-package/inclusion-support-program

Documentary evidence

As outlined in the Conditions of Funding, You must retain evidence of the eligible child/children on the IS Case and the Additional Educator. This includes:

- evidence of the child/children's attendance, such as sign in and sign out sheet with parent signature
- additional educator attendance, such as time sheets signed by the Additional Educator.

Payment of the IDF Subsidy

The IDF Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited Support is paid directly to You, from the department, to the same bank account You nominated in your application.

Following an approved claim, You will typically receive payment within 4-6 business days, depending your bank.

Payment of claims will occur where the child approved on the IS Case attended the service. Payment of Non Face-to-Face claims will occur without the attendance of the child.

Changes in the care environment

The IDF Subsidy for Immediate/Time Limited Support can only be approved once for a service for the same child.

If You require ongoing support from an Additional Educator to include the child, You should apply for the IDF Subsidy for an Additional Educator.

Please Note: Requests for IDF Subsidy for an Additional Educator must be submitted on the IS Portal a minimum of 4 weeks prior to date the support is required.

Terminating this Approval

By the Service

If You no longer require the Approved IS Case for Immediate/Time Limited support, You must notify the IDF Manager within 10 business days of becoming aware of this. You will be required to provide the date that funding should cease (i.e. the new Case end date) and a reason funding is no longer required.

This will allow funding allocations in the IDF to be managed more effectively and enable funds to be redirected to maximise the support provided to ECEC services through ISP.

By the Commonwealth

If You are found to be in breach of any terms contained in this Approval Letter or the Conditions of Funding, Your approved IS Case may be terminated, future claims may not be able to be submitted and payments may be withheld. You may also be required to repay any amounts You have received whilst in breach. You will receive written notice of any termination. On receipt of a notice of termination, You must take all reasonable steps to minimise loss resulting from that cancellation and You will not be entitled to compensation for loss after the end date specified in the notice of termination.

This includes where it is found that You have provided false or misleading statements in the application. You are reminded that providing false or misleading information is a criminal offence.

Contacts

If you have any queries about your approval please contact:

	Contact Name	Contact Phone	Contact Email
--	--------------	---------------	---------------

IDF Manager	Stream Coordinator	(18) 0082 4955	idfmsupport@deloitte.com.au
Inclusion Agency	Sheree Jones	(18) 0070 3382	inclusionagency@includeme.com.au

Information about the ISP, including complaints mechanisms and appeals processes, is available on the IDF Manager's website, which can be accessed through the department's website at www.education.gov.au/child-care-package/inclusion-support-program

Inclusion Development Fund Manager
Inclusion Support Program

Conditions of Funding: IDF Subsidy and FDC Top Up

The Grove Academy - North Wollongong agreed to the following Conditions of Funding upon submission of Your application for IDF Subsidy for an Additional Educator. Your application was submitted by Emma McCauley on 11/11/2025.

You must comply with the New ISP Guidelines Version 2.4 September 2022. This includes (but is not limited to):

- Use of the funding for the purposes as stated in the Approval Letter sent by the Inclusion Development Fund Manager (IDF Manager)
- Submitting online claims for IDF payments within 60 days of the fortnight that the child/ren on the approved IS Case attended the service
- Retaining relevant evidence pertaining to the use of the funding, including sign in and sign out sheets of the eligible child/ren on the approved IS Case, Additional Educator attendance or record of payment to the FDC educator
- Complying with the Privacy Act 1988 and the Australian Privacy Principles when handling personal information for the purposes of the Inclusion Support Program
- Advising the IDF Manager via the IS Portal within 15 business days if the child/ren on the approved IS Case no longer attends the service.
- Advising the IDF Manager in writing within 30 days of any intention of the service to change owner and/or operator
- Meeting all reasonable requests from the IDF Manager or department to undertake compliance activity where appropriate, including reasonable assistance to provide access to your employees, premises occupied by you and materials relevant to the IDF Subsidy. Reasonable notice will be provided prior to requiring access to premises and records.
- Meeting all reasonable requests from the IDF Manager or department to participate in reporting and evaluation activities for the Inclusion Support Program
- Complying with all relevant statutes, regulations, by-laws and requirements of any Commonwealth, State, Territory or local authority, and any of the department's policies notified in writing

If you are found to be in breach of any of the conditions, your approved IS Case may be terminated, future claims may not be able to be submitted and payments may be withheld. You may also be required to repay any amounts you have received whilst in breach.